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This project is developed as part of the **Digital Literacy** course, where the role of a Student Digital Ambassador is simulated. The objective is to build a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio that demonstrates essential skills required to navigate the modern digital environment effectively. The project involves five structured tasks, including creating an **awareness infographic**, developing a **professional digital portfolio**, exploring **coding and collaboration platforms**, practicing **email etiquette**, and analyzing **cybercrime scenarios**. Through these activities, the project emphasizes responsible online behavior, professional communication, and awareness of digital risks. Overall, it reflects a practical approach to understanding how students can build a credible digital presence while ensuring safety, productivity, and ethical engagement in the digital world.

Task 1 – Infographic

Description of Design For this task, I acted as a Student Digital Ambassador to create a visual resource aimed at helping my batchmates understand the core pillars of digital literacy. I utilized **Prezi** to design an interactive infographic that covers three essential topics: what digital literacy truly entails, a curated list of useful digital tools for B.Tech students (such as GitHub and Canva), and a section dedicated to safe internet practices. The design follows a non-linear path, starting with a broad definition and zooming into specific, actionable advice for students. I used a professional blue and white color scheme to maintain a clean, academic look while incorporating icons to make the information more digestible at a glance.

Reflection What I found particularly interesting about using Prezi was its "zoomable" canvas, which allowed me to show the "big picture" of digital literacy before diving into finer details without cluttering the screen. This spatial way of organizing information felt more dynamic than a standard static poster. However, one thing I found difficult was balancing the amount of text on each "planet" or bubble; I had to learn how to keep my descriptions concise so the visual flow remained engaging. Overall, this process helped me realize that digital literacy isn't just about knowing how to use a computer, but also about choosing the right medium to communicate information effectively to an audience.

Task 2 – Digital Portfolio

For Task 2, I set up professional profiles on **GitHub**, **stackoverflow**, and **Kaggle** to establish a foundational digital presence. Each platform serves a distinct purpose in academic and professional development. **GitHub** is primarily used for version control and showcasing projects, making it essential for demonstrating coding skills and maintaining a portfolio. **stackoverflow** is a popular Q&A platform where developers and students post technical coding problems to get solutions from a global community of experts. It serves as an open source knowledge base. **Kaggle**, on the other hand, is focused on data science and machine learning, providing access to datasets, competitions, and practical problem-solving environments.

Looking ahead, I plan to actively maintain and improve these profiles over the next four years. On GitHub, I intend to regularly upload projects and document my development process. On LinkedIn, I aim to build a strong professional network and engage with relevant content. For Kaggle, I plan to participate in competitions and enhance my analytical and problem-solving skills. Overall, these platforms will collectively support my academic growth and career readiness.

Task 3 – Platforms

Description of Activities For the coding practice portion of this task, I used **HackerRank**, where I successfully completed the "Solve Me First" beginner-level challenge. This involved implementing a function to calculate the sum of two integers, helping me familiarize myself with the platform's environment and competitive programming structure. For the collaboration portion, I built a **Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz** using **Google Forms**. The form consists of exactly five questions, including both multiple-choice and short-answer formats, designed to test my batchmates' knowledge on topics like password security and identifying misinformation. I also linked the form to a **Google Sheet** to track and view responses in real-time.

Reflection Practicing on HackerRank was a great way to transition from classroom theory to practical problem-solving; it taught me the importance of reading constraints carefully before writing code. Building the Google Form was equally valuable as it showed me how cloud collaboration tools can be used to gather and analyze data quickly. Academically, these tools will be essential throughout my B.Tech journey, as HackerRank will help me prepare for technical interviews while Google Workspace will streamline my group projects and research data collection.

Task 4 – Email Etiquette

Communication Scenario and Analysis One common situation where poor digital communication causes significant problems is when a student sends an overly casual or demanding email to a professor without a clear subject line or formal greeting. For example, a student might send a message saying "Hey, can I get more time on the lab?" from a personal email address without stating their name or course. This often leads to the professor ignoring the request or the email being flagged as spam, causing the student to miss the deadline entirely. To prevent this, I practiced drafting a professional extension request that uses a clear subject line, a respectful tone, and a specific justification for the delay.

Key Learnings Through this task, I learned that professional communication is about more than just being polite; it is about providing all necessary context to the recipient to save them time. A well-structured email with a proper salutation and sign-off ensures that the message is taken seriously. Additionally, creating the "Social Media Do's and Don'ts" checklist helped me realize that as a college student, my online presence acts as a permanent resume. I now understand that maintaining a professional digital footprint—such as avoiding public "cyber-arguments" and verifying facts before sharing—is a critical skill for my future career.

Task 5 – Cybercrime

Research Reflections While researching the **UPI/Online Payment Fraud** case study, what surprised me most was how attackers rarely use complex hacking techniques; instead, they rely almost entirely on **social engineering**. I was shocked to learn that a simple "Collect Request" or a fake "Refund" call can lead to immediate financial loss just by tricking a user into entering their UPI PIN. It made me realize that even tech-savvy students are vulnerable if they are caught off guard or are unfamiliar with the specific UI triggers of payment apps.

Habit Change As a result of this research, one habit I will personally change is **enabling Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)** on all my primary accounts and being extremely cautious with unsolicited calls or WhatsApp forwards. I have also decided to never enter my UPI PIN

References

unless I am the one intentionally initiating a payment to a known recipient. Additionally, I have saved the **National Cyber Crime Helpline number (1930)** in my contacts so that I can act quickly within the "Golden Hour" if I or a peer ever faces a digital scam that they often contain critical security patches. Additionally, I will be more cautious with emails and downloads, especially from unknown sources, to reduce the risk of unintentionally introducing malware into my system.

Conclusion

This project provided a structured introduction to essential aspects of digital literacy, combining practical tasks with real-world relevance. Through the different modules, I developed a clearer understanding of how to create and manage a professional digital presence, communicate effectively in formal contexts, and use online tools for both learning and collaboration. The hands-on experience with platforms like GitHub, stackoverflow, HackerRank, and Google Forms reinforced the importance of adaptability and continuous skill development in a digital environment. Additionally, exploring cybersecurity topics highlighted the risks associated with careless online behavior and the need for proactive safety measures. Overall, the project emphasized that digital literacy is not just about technical skills, but also about responsible, ethical, and informed participation in the digital world.

1. Prizo
2. GitHub - github.com
3. Stack Overflow - stackoverflow.com
4. Kaggle – kaggle.com
5. HackerRank – hackerrank.com
6. Google Forms - forms.google.com
7. Wikipedia – [Wikipedia.com](https://wikipedia.com)